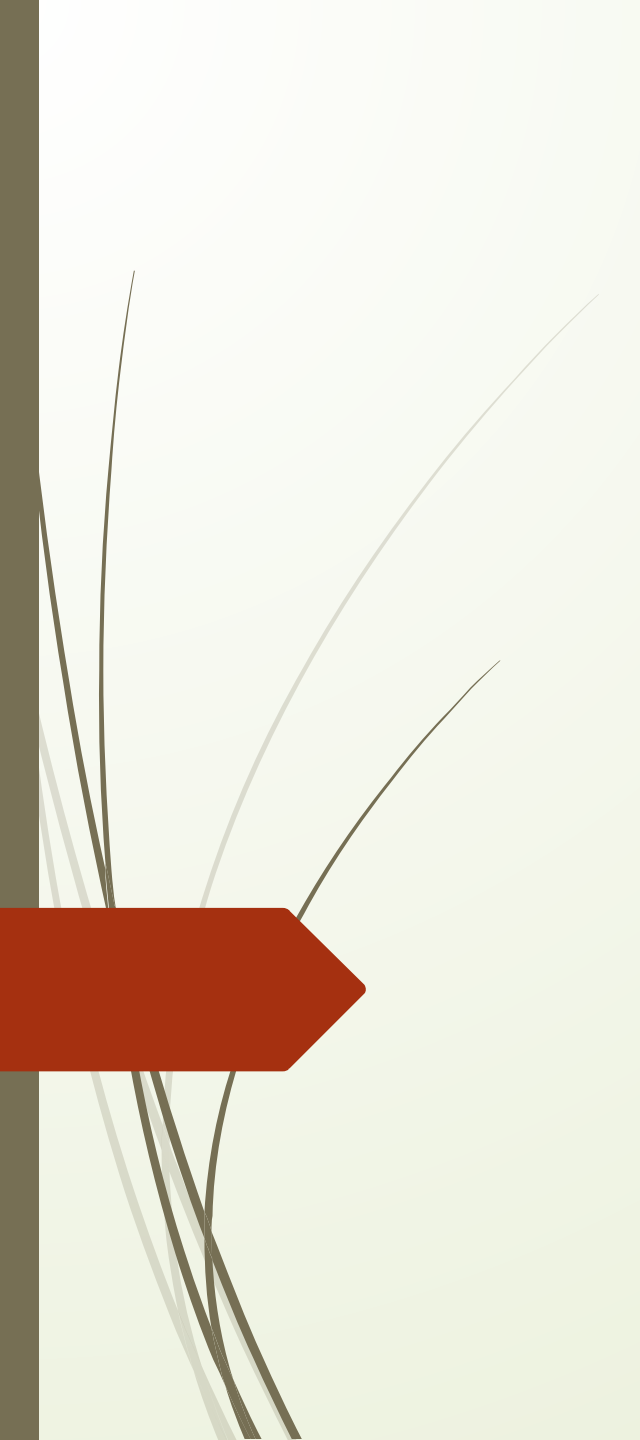
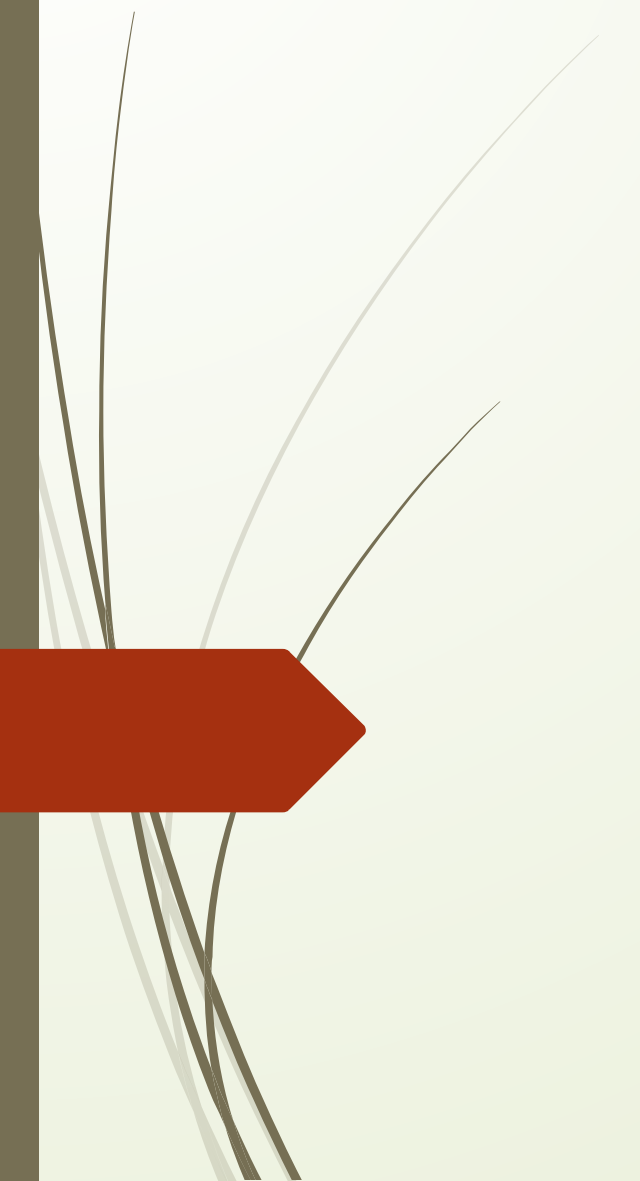




Functional English

Javeriya Ahmed Hussain



The Academic Essay Writing Process

The Essay

An essay is a written composition on a single topic or subject performing one of the following functions:

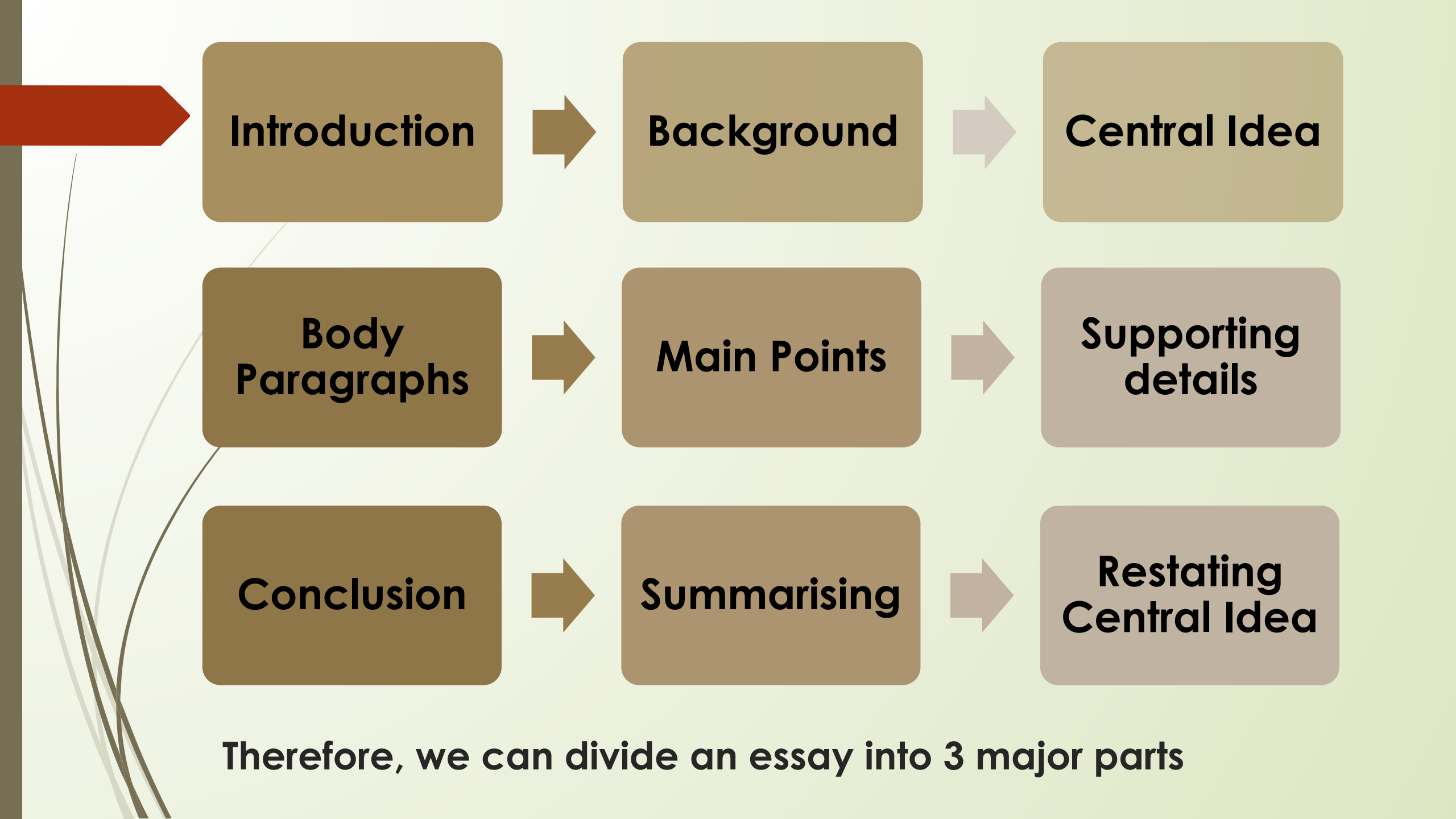
- Informing about a given topic
- Describing something / Narrating something
- Arguing against or in favour of something
- Comparing something with something else
- Analyze something
- Evaluating something, and so on

Usually, **the academic essay** is a written composition which treats the respective topic in a neutral & objective way.



STANDARD ACADEMIC ESSAY:

- It must contain 5 paragraphs and a maximum of 350 words
- The first and the last paragraphs are designated to introducing and concluding the topic
- The middle three paragraphs are reserved for the main body of an essay
- Techniques of writing and the structure of paragraphs may differ in accordance with the type of the essay



Introduction

Background

Central Idea

**Body
Paragraphs**

Main Points

**Supporting
details**

Conclusion

Summarising

**Restating
Central Idea**

Therefore, we can divide an essay into 3 major parts



Writing is Not a Magic



The Process of Writing

Writing is a process and for that there are different steps.

□ Step 1: Assessing the writing situation:

The Topic: Focus on key words.

The Purpose: Your aim behind writing (inform, persuade, argue, describe, evaluate, etc.).

Audience: Understand your readers (as in age, background, gender). It guides you to select your material, vocabulary, style, and attitude).

Tone: The voice of the writer (depends on the audience, subject matter, purpose, and domain of writing).

Understanding the Topic

□ Here are some possible subjects for an essay (300 words). Mark each subject as 'too broad' or 'about right'.

1. World war II
2. Nuclear power
3. Computers
4. The whooping crane's struggle for survival
5. Pollution
6. The difficulties of living in one-parent family
7. Technology
8. Honesty
9. Marriage
10. Getting a job

Analysing titles

Be clear what the title is asking before starting to plan the essay

- To identify the main requirements of the title
- To determine the organization of the essay

For example:

Academic qualifications are of little practical benefit in the real world – Discuss

- Discussing involves examining the benefits and drawbacks of something.

Relate the development of railways to the rise of nineteenth-century European nationalism.

- Relate means to link one thing to another.

Activity

□ Underline the **key words** in the following titles and consider what they are asking you to do.

1. Define Information Technology (IT) and outline its main applications in medicine.
2. Compare and contrast the appeal process in the legal systems of Britain and the USA.
3. Evaluate the effect of mergers in the motor industry in the last ten years.
4. Trace the development of primary education in Britain. Illustrate some of the issues currently facing this sector.

Activity

Match the terms to the definitions on the right

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Analyse | Give a clear and simple account |
| ☐ Describe | Make a proposal and support it |
| ☐ Examine | Deal with a complex subject by giving the main points |
| ☐ State | Divide into sections and discuss each critically |
| ☐ Suggest | Give a detailed account |
| ☐ Summarise | Look at the various parts and their relationships |



Answers

- Analyse: Divide into sections and discuss each critically
- Describe: Give a detailed account
- Examine: Look at the various parts and their relationships
- State: Give a clear and simple account
- Suggest: Make a proposal and support it
- Summarise: Deal with a complex subject by giving the main points

Analyse means to inspect critically while examine is to observe carefully



Purpose of Writing

Activity is on pg. # 70-71



Home task is on pg. # 72



Audience Analysis Activity : Let's read two paragraphs taken from different essays and articles. Read and decide who the target audience is in each case.

Plagiarism is the fraudulent representation of another person's language, thoughts, ideas, or expressions as one's own original work. Although precise definitions vary depending on the institution, in many countries and cultures plagiarism is considered a violation of academic integrity and journalistic ethics, as well as social norms around learning, teaching, research, fairness, respect, and responsibility. As such, a person or entity that is determined to have committed plagiarism is often subject to various punishments or sanctions, such as suspension, expulsion from school or work, fines, imprisonment, and other penalties.



It's important to know what plagiarism is, and what form it takes (some common types of plagiarism are listed here). It's also important to **know how plagiarism happens**. The final step is to **develop effective academic skills**. Many students who plagiarise do so unintentionally, often because they don't have the academic skills to avoid over-reliance on the work of others or because they aren't sure what constitutes plagiarism. So it's important to take every opportunity to develop your academic skills.



Tone

- Based on your topic, purpose, audience, and domain of writing, tone will be decided.

Activity 1 is on pg. # 73

Step 2: Planning (Pre-Writing):

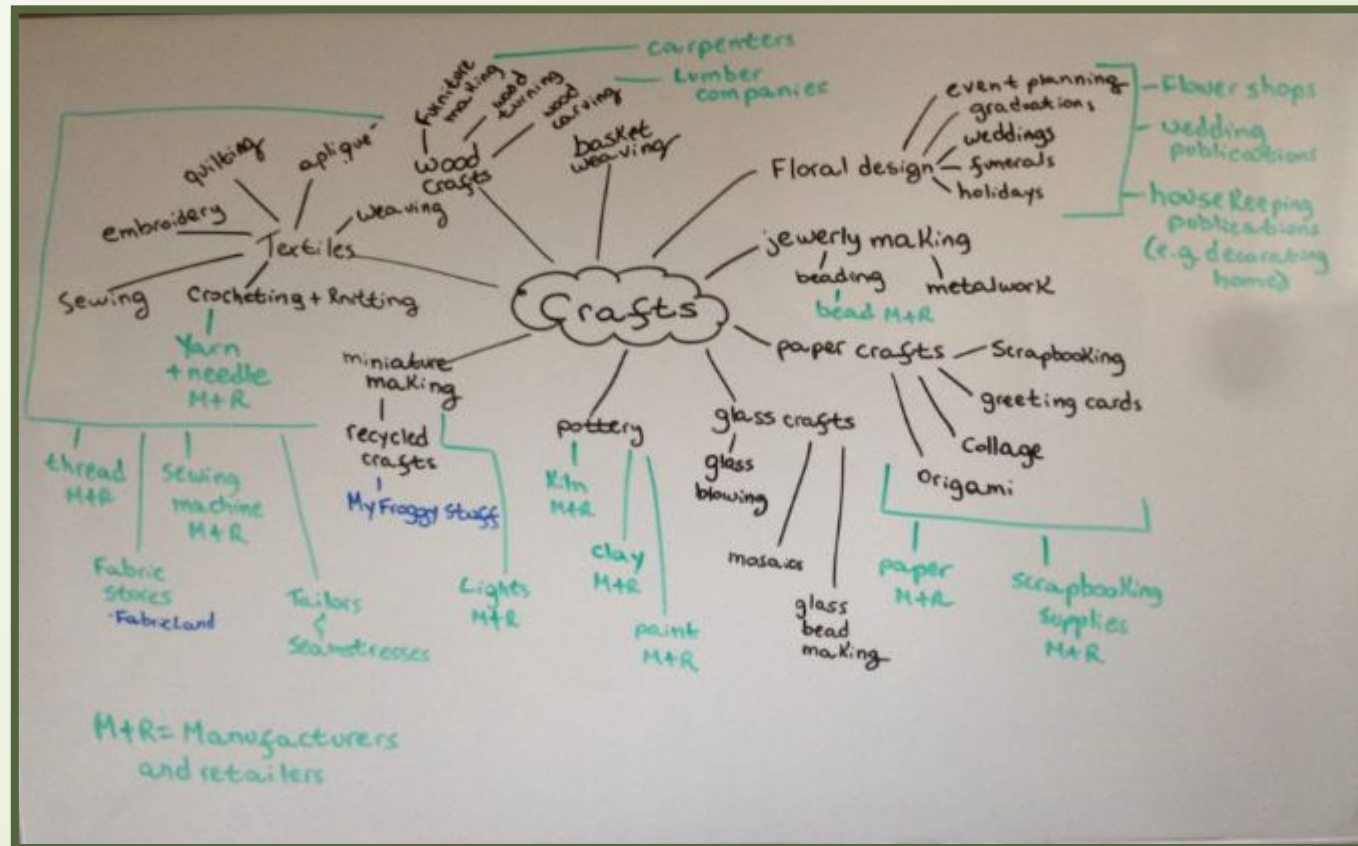
First, plan your writing. Following things are done in the planning stage:

Generating ideas: you can use the following techniques to come up with ideas:

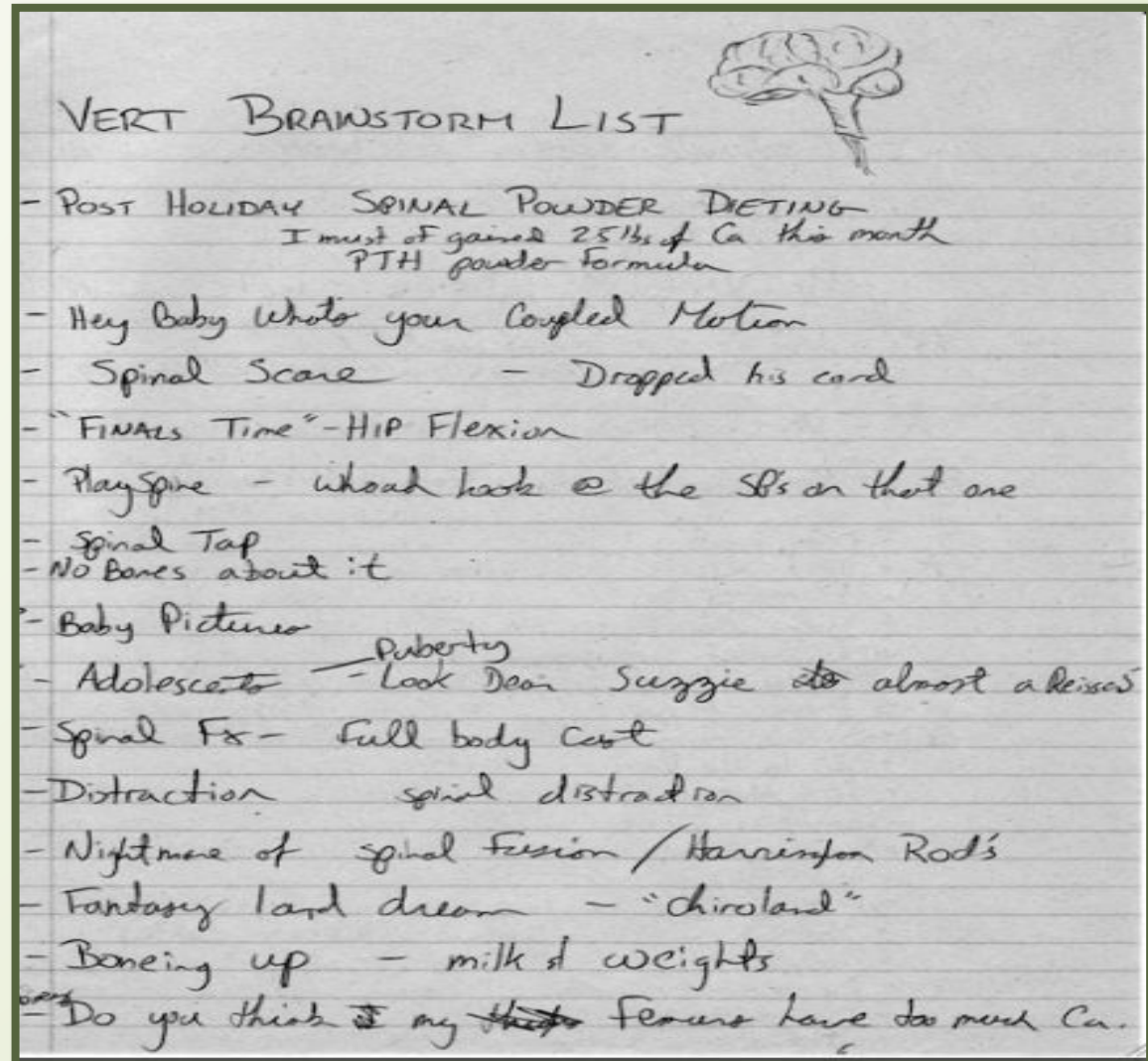
- Brainstorming(pg. 74): Jot down all the ideas that come to your mind ignoring issues like relevance or importance of ideas and points. Scan your brain for any prior knowledge you have about the topic.

Methods of Brainstorming:

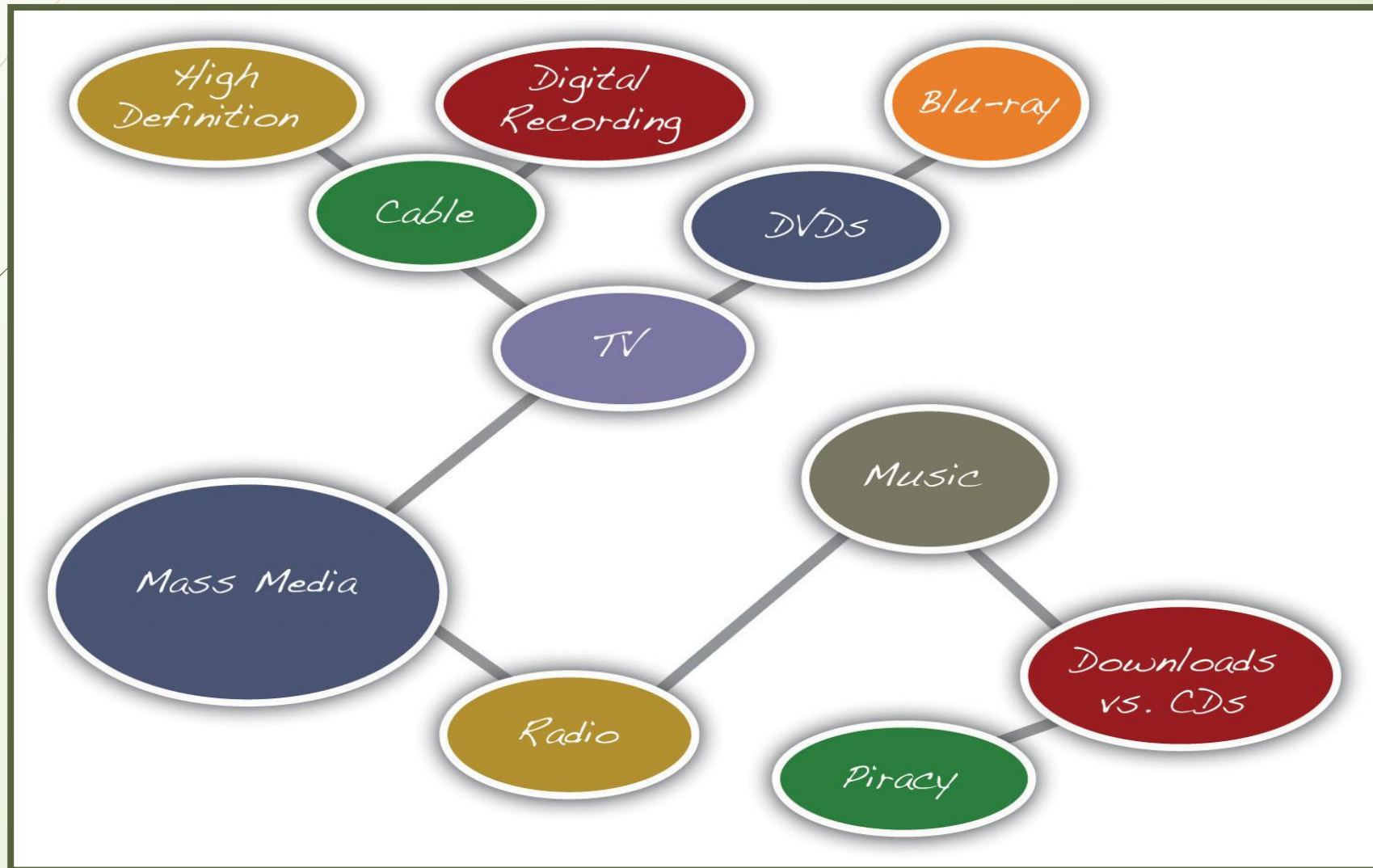
- Mind mapping: This technique involves identifying a central topic (often represented as an image) and creating branches indicating the relevant categories that are related to the central topic extending radially from the central idea (Budd, 2004)



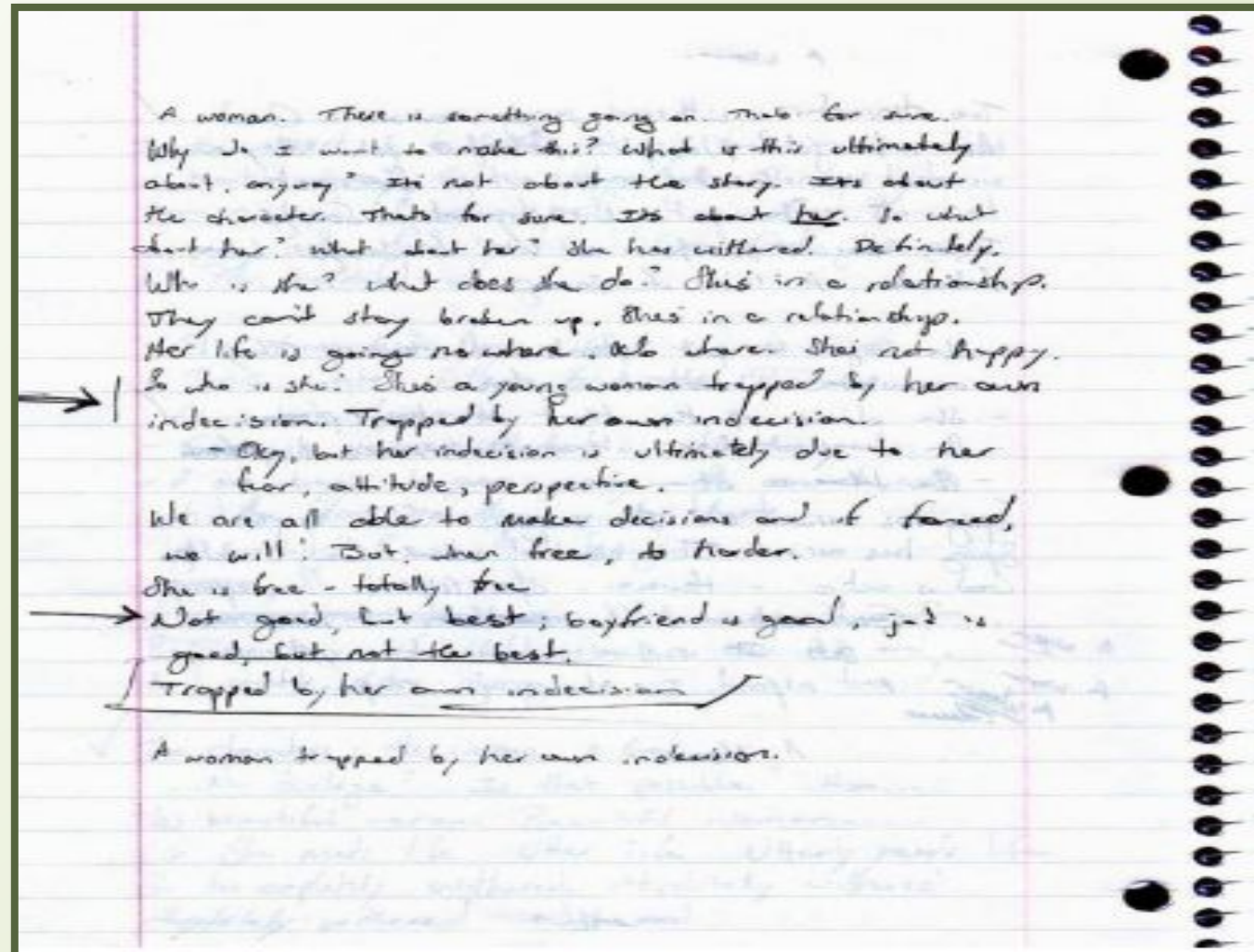
- Listing: Listing is a process of producing a lot of information within a short time by generating some broad ideas and then building on those associations for more detail with a bullet point list.



- Clustering(pg. 75): Clustering involves more focused thinking.



- Free writing: It is to practice writing in general. Used as a preliminary to more formal writing. It involves continuous writing, usually for predetermined period of time.



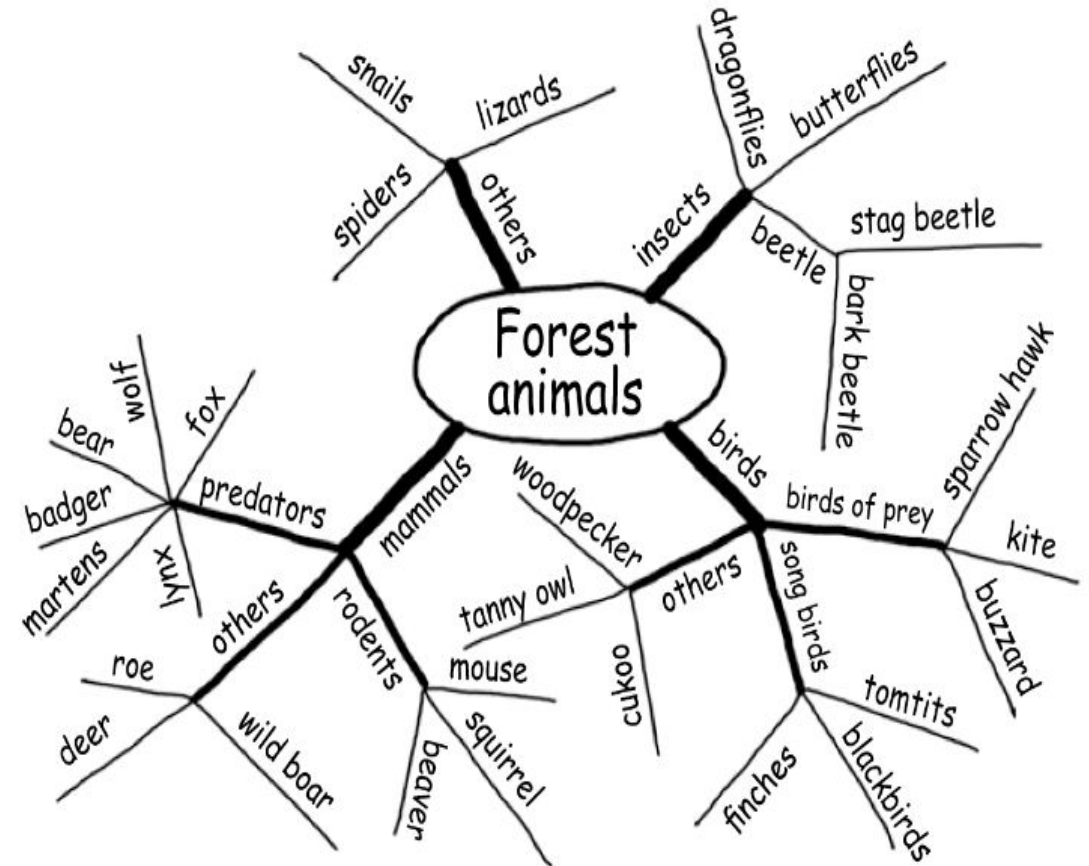
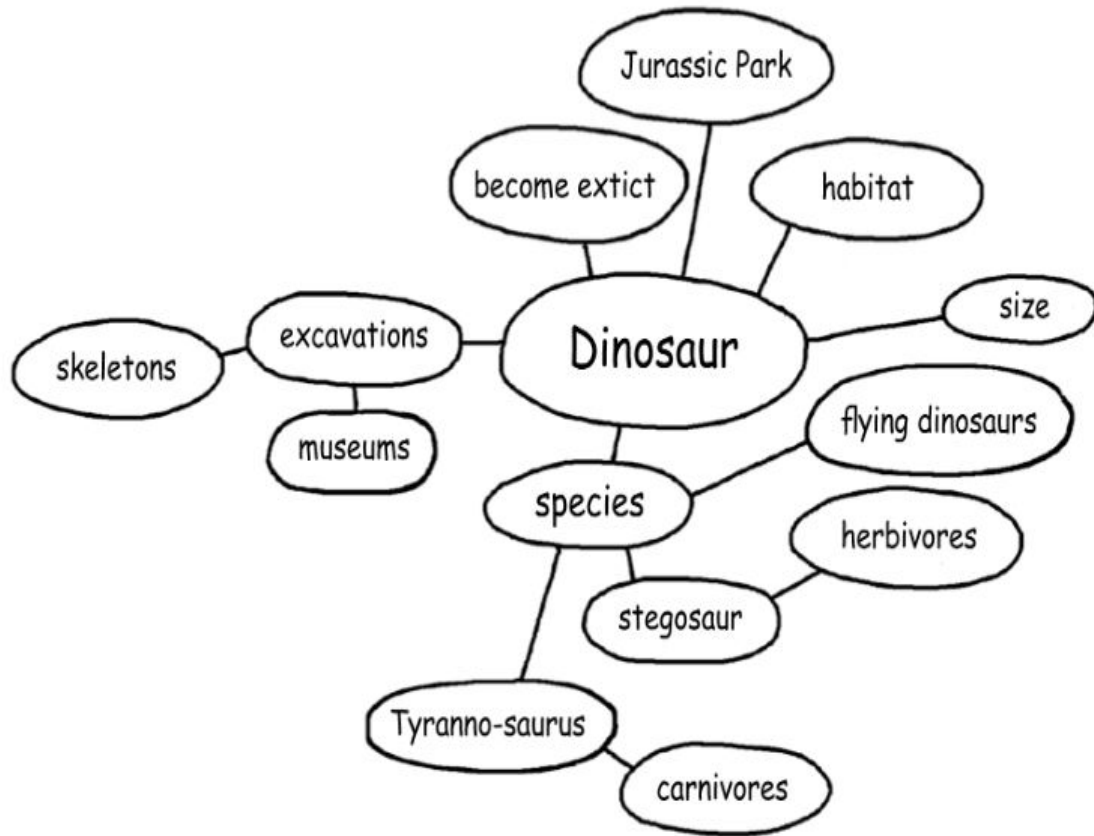


□ Discussion: Discussion can also be very helpful in generating ideas. Jot down the ideas in a notebook. Scan and review your ideas. Select the most relevant and important ones and decide for a logical order. Other than this, you can search for ideas by reading books on the essay topic, or surf the net. Skim and scan sites or books.

Then, organize them into **an outline** for your essay by arranging them in a logical order.

Once you have a rough outline containing ideas for your essay, it is time to move on to the next step of the writing process.

Practice





Practice: Brainstorm some ideas for 300 words essay following the assigned method and topic.

- Innovative Solutions for Campus Sustainability.
 - Climate Change and Our Responsibility Towards It.
- 



Step 3: Reading:

- After planning, reading is done.
 - It helps in getting more ideas, vocabulary, sentence structures, etc.
 - Add the new information in your outline.
 - Revise and finalize it.
- 



■ **Step 4: Rough Writing:**

- Once you have a final outline, write a rough draft ignoring grammatical and organizational concerns.
- Most writers find beginning with the introduction paragraph difficult. So, they begin with the main body of the essay, and then write an introduction paragraph.
- Your outline and ideas undergo considerable revision at this stage.
- After having written the rough draft, it is now time to bring into consideration the issues you ignored in order not to disturb a spontaneous flow of ideas.



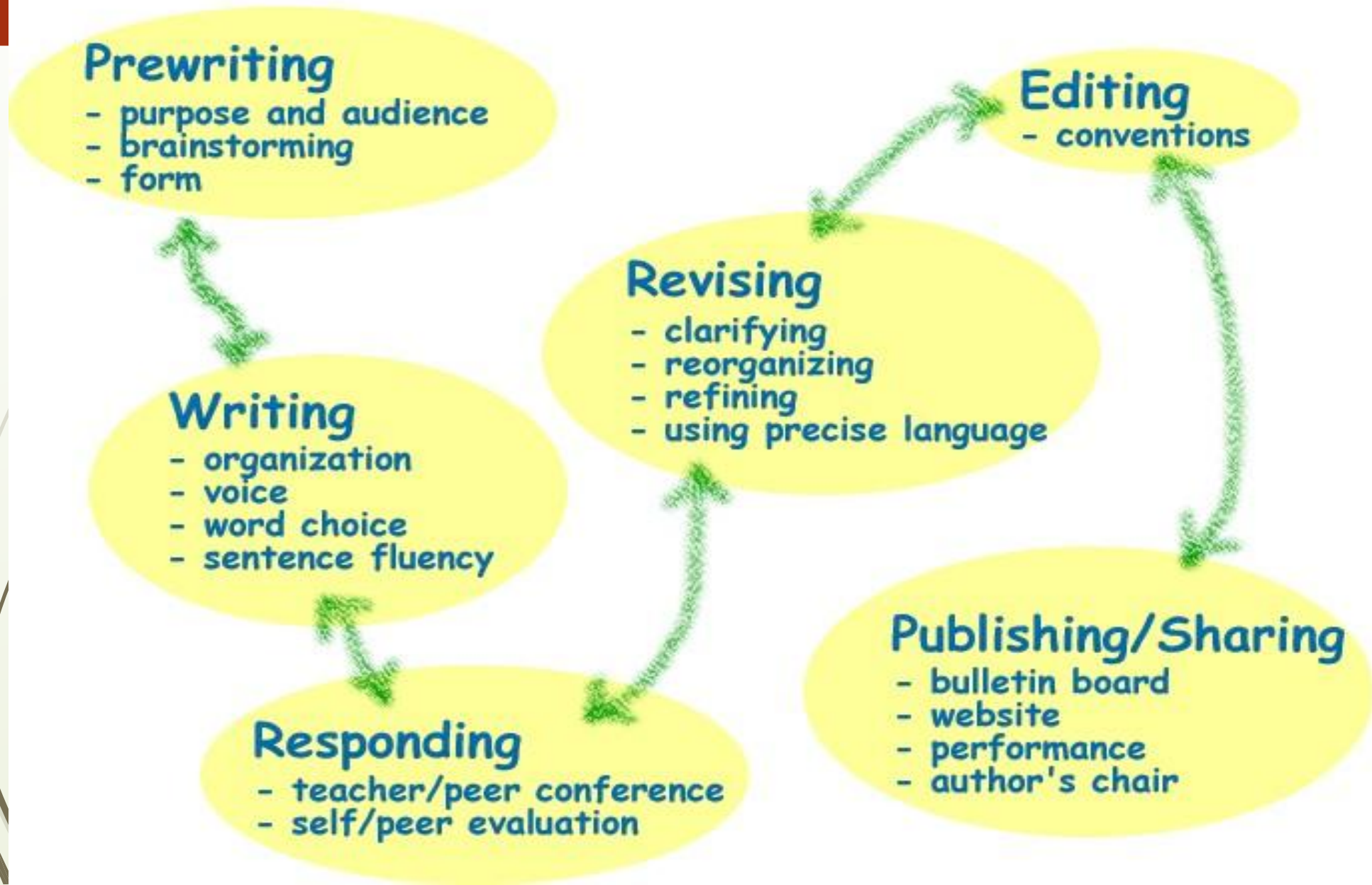
Step 5: Proofreading/Editing/Revising:

- Check your essay for grammatical, structural and organizational mistakes, unity and coherence, etc.

Step 6: Final Draft Writing:

- After proofreading and editing, write a final draft of your essay.

The Writing Process





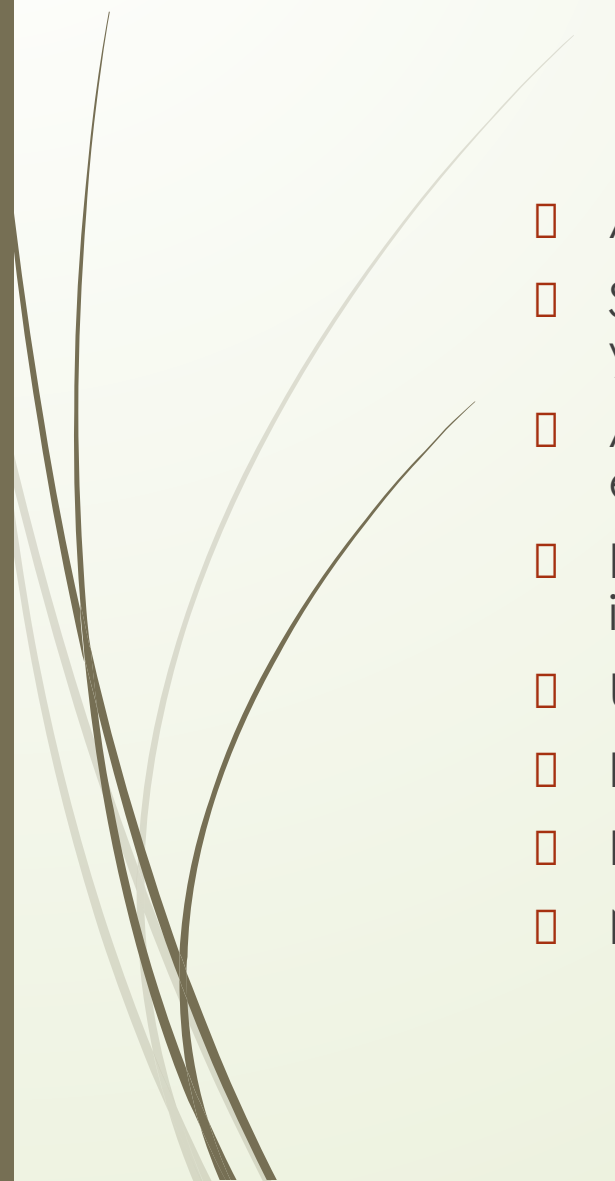
Outline



- Schematic(simplified) plan of an essay. It displays the important ideas/points that are to be discussed.
- It functions like a map guiding the writer in organizing his/her points/ideas in the essay. It tells one where and when to discuss a given point



STEPS IN MAKING OUTLINES



- ❑ After generating ideas, analyze them.
- ❑ Select the most relevant ideas, or the ones which are directly related to your essay topic.
- ❑ According to the word limit, select 3 major issues/ideas/points for your essay.
- ❑ Decide for a logical order for your ideas depending on the degree of importance with respect to the topic.
- ❑ Use phrases, headings, or keywords.
- ❑ For each body paragraph, select relevant MPs, and SDs.
- ❑ Revise and finalize it.
- ❑ Now follow it and write a rough draft for your essay

NOTE:

Outline should have

- ✓ The introduction paragraph
- ✓ The 3 body paragraphs
- ✓ The conclusion paragraph

Thank you 😊